

PRAYAGH CONSUMER CARE LALWANIS' ODE TO INDIA'S SWEET STORY



VINOD LALWANI
Executive Director
Prayagh Consumer Products Pvt Ltd

An enterprise founded in the year 2000 as a contract manufacturer for ITC Ltd. (Foods Division), Prayagh Consumer Care defines the success story of the Lalwanis as they race towards the Rs. 1500 Cr. Turnover landmark.

Prayagh Consumer Care can trace its origin to an exclusive contract for manufacturing the CANDYMAN range of Hard-boiled Sugar Confectionery, Toffees and Eclairs for M/S. ITC Ltd. (Foods Division). The company has since grown leaps and bounds with its own portfolio of close to 400 SKUs, ranging from Toffees to Lollipops, Chocolate Enrobed Wafers to Shell Moulded chocolates. With two brands that cater to various stratas of society, they are reaching out to consumers far and wide with a very distinct strategy for each market. Cintu caters to the rural and hinterland markets, while Lavian has a bigger concentration in metro and urban markets. Lavian Exotique is a recent strategic launch consisting of a premium set of products for the discerning customer.

The Managing Director, Preetam Bhawandas Lalwani has used his versatile networking skills to build an enormous distribution network in a short span of time to craft the success of the company. Vinod Preetam Lalwani, a post graduate in Food Technology from CFTRI Mysore, with his vast experience in production, quality and R&D operations brings in not just technical expertise but also passion and drive. It is due to the combined efforts of

these masterminds, and a team of equally passionate and dedicated employees that Prayagh Consumer Care has been able to emerge as the 5th Largest Player in the Confectionery category, 6th Largest in the Chocolate category & 5th Largest in the Cakes category as per Nielsen data.

Prayagh Consumer Care operates 3 Manufacturing Plants manned by 1300+ employees to cater to over 8 Lakh outlets across the country. From selling in a few regional markets to exporting to over 25 countries, the company has come a long way. The company is gearing up to achieve a challenging growth target of INR 1500 crores by FY 25-26, which will place Prayagh Consumer Care among the top 3 players in each of the categories it operates.

Vinod Lalwani reminisces, "In 2009, we started Plant 2 with a huge investment of INR 30 Crores. While it did feel like a big challenge, I was very confident about the growing consumption story of India and that it will take Prayagh from INR 150 Crores to INR 500 Crores per annum. It was a big risk and it has definitely paid off. It's impossible to go wrong by betting on the greatness of our nation! So don't be afraid of taking risks and be assured "....no risk... no gain".

Vinod says that there is no shortcut to success. It always starts with a strong vision, implemented through diligent planning & effective execution cemented further by your passion to grow & excel. He says, "I had to utilize my potential to deliver great tasting products in the most efficient way possible. It was my desire to feed the consumers not just in the domestic markets but also across the globe. This strong desire and ambition, has not dimmed across these years. I still yearn to enhance our standards further and reach out to more consumers, transforming our organization into a truly global entity".

With such clarity of thought and a wonderful spirit to excel, the Lalwanis have extended its domain expertise to innovative products across the categories they operate in to emerge as a Global Market Leader.

The Lalwanis' passion is infectious just like their goodies. How can the world resist?